

Exploring space

We can learn a lot about what is in space by watching from Earth. However, by traveling into space, we can get a better look and even see things that are invisible from Earth. Astronomers regularly send out satellites and space probes. Astronauts—human space travelers—have also explored space close to Earth.



Getting the message

On Earth, big dishes work like enormous ears, collecting the radio messages sent by space probes.

Galileo

A space probe called *Galileo* was sent on a mission to Jupiter in 1989. It took *Galileo* six years to reach Jupiter, even though space probes travel very fast. Once at Jupiter, *Galileo* spent eight years touring around the giant planet and its moons.

